

Table Wars Competition

A spirited evening of friendly rivalry between dinner table groups. Five rounds of trivia, relays, building challenges, taste tests, and a grand finale quiz, all culminating in the ultimate prize: first position at mealtimes for an entire week.

Program Outline

Boarding House Activities Committee

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1. Event Overview

The **Table Wars Competition** is the signature Week 4 event of the Boarding House Entertainment Schedule. This spirited event pits dinner table groups against one another in a series of fun, high-energy challenges designed to build camaraderie, spark friendly rivalry, and bring the entire boarding house community together. Every resident is already seated at a dinner table, which means teams are formed organically without the need for drafts or selections, ensuring that everyone participates and no one is left out.

The competition draws its intensity from a highly coveted prize: the winning table earns the right to be **first in line at meal times** for the following week. In a boarding house setting where food is a central part of daily life, this privilege is both practical and symbolic. It guarantees the champions the hottest meals and the widest selection, while also conferring bragging rights that resonate well beyond the dining hall. This simple yet powerful incentive drives genuine enthusiasm and competitive spirit among all participants.

The event is structured to accommodate a wide range of skills and interests. From intellectual trivia to physical relays, from creative construction to sensory challenges, every round offers a different type of test. This variety ensures that every team member can contribute meaningfully, regardless of whether their strengths lie in quick thinking, physical agility, artistic flair, or culinary instinct. The overall experience is designed to be inclusive, memorable, and filled with laughter.

2. Objectives

The Table Wars Competition is designed with several key objectives in mind, each contributing to the overall boarding house experience and community spirit. These objectives ensure the event is not merely a pastime but a meaningful part of the residential programme that strengthens social bonds and creates lasting memories.

â■¢ **Foster Team Spirit:** By competing as a dinner table group, residents develop a sense of loyalty and belonging that extends beyond the competition itself. Tables that eat together every day now have the chance to strategize, celebrate, and support one another in a shared challenge, deepening the connections that already exist from daily mealtime interactions.

â■¢ **Encourage Friendly Rivalry:** Healthy competition brings out the best in people. The Table Wars format ensures that rivalry remains good-natured by emphasizing fun over winning-at-all-costs, with challenges that reward creativity and cooperation just as much as speed or strength.

â■¢ **Promote Inclusivity:** Because teams are determined by existing dinner table assignments, there is no risk of anyone being excluded or picked last. Every resident is automatically on a team, and the diverse challenge format ensures that everyone has a moment to shine regardless of their individual talents.

â■¢ **Build Community Bonds:** The shared experience of competing, cheering, and laughing together strengthens the overall sense of community within the boarding house. Residents

who may not typically interact across table groups will find themselves engaging with new people during the event.

♣ **Create Lasting Memories:** The unique and often hilarious moments generated during Table Wars, from collapsed cardboard towers to blind taste test surprises, become stories that residents retell for weeks afterward, enriching the social fabric of the house.

3. Team Structure

Teams are formed based on the existing dinner table seating arrangements within the boarding house. Each dinner table constitutes one team, ensuring natural groupings that residents are already comfortable with. This approach eliminates the awkwardness of team selection and guarantees full participation from every resident.

3.1 Team Composition

Each team should have a designated **Team Captain** who serves as the primary point of contact between the team and the event organisers. The captain is responsible for relaying instructions, coordinating team strategy, and ensuring that all team members know when and where they need to be during each round. Captains should be chosen democratically by their table groups, ideally during dinner on the evening before the event to allow time for brief strategic planning.

Role	Responsibility	Selection
Team Captain	Lead strategy, communicate with organisers, motivate team	Elected by table group
Vice Captain	Assist captain, manage substitutions, handle disputes	Appointed by captain
Team Members	Participate in challenges, support teammates, cheer on team	All table residents

Table 1: Team Roles and Responsibilities

3.2 Team Identity

To enhance the competitive atmosphere and build team spirit, each table group is encouraged to create a unique team identity. This includes choosing a **team name** (something memorable and appropriate), selecting a **team colour** or visual identifier (such as matching headbands, armbands, or face paint), and developing a **team chant or cheer** that can be performed during the opening ceremony. These elements add vibrancy to the event and give each team a distinct personality that spectators and opponents will remember.

4. Competition Rounds

The Table Wars Competition consists of five main rounds, each testing a different skill set. The variety ensures that no single team can dominate purely based on one type of ability, and that every team member has an opportunity to contribute. Points are awarded for placement in each round, with cumulative scoring determining the overall champion.

4.1 Round 1: Table Trivia Challenge

The competition opens with a fast-paced trivia round that tests general knowledge, boarding house history, pop culture, and current events. Each team is given a buzzer or hand-raise system, and the host reads questions aloud. Teams have ten seconds to confer and provide an answer. Correct answers earn points, while wrong answers allow other teams to steal. This round rewards quick thinking and broad knowledge, and often produces dramatic come-from-behind moments that set the tone for the rest of the competition.

Format: 20 questions, 10 seconds per question, steal rules in effect

Points: 5 points per correct answer, 3 points for a steal

Participants: Entire team may confer, captain delivers the final answer

4.2 Round 2: Food Relay Race

In this physical and hilarious round, teams compete in a relay race with a culinary twist. Each team member must carry a plate of food (or a food-related item such as a tray of cups or a bowl of water) across the gymnasium while navigating obstacles such as cones, hurdles, and balance beams. If any item falls off the plate, the participant must return to the starting line and begin that leg again. The next runner can only start once the previous runner has successfully handed off the plate. This round tests coordination, speed, and composure under pressure, and the spectacle of food-themed chaos never fails to draw cheers from the audience.

Format: Timed relay, 4-6 runners per team depending on team size

Points: 1st place = 25 pts, 2nd = 20 pts, 3rd = 15 pts, 4th = 10 pts, 5th+ = 5 pts

Penalty: -3 points per dropped item that is not recovered

4.3 Round 3: Table Building Challenge

Teams are given a set of materials (cardboard boxes, newspaper, tape, string, plastic cups, and other household items) and must construct the tallest free-standing structure within a time limit. The structure must be able to support a small weight (such as a tennis ball) at its highest point for at least ten seconds without collapsing. This round rewards engineering creativity, spatial reasoning, and teamwork. It is often the most visually impressive round, with some teams building surprisingly elaborate towers and others creating clever but unconventional designs. Judges evaluate both height and structural integrity.

Format: 15-minute build time, materials provided

Points: Height ranking (1st = 25 pts, 2nd = 20 pts, 3rd = 15 pts, 4th = 10 pts, 5th+ = 5 pts) + 5 bonus points for creative design

Participants: Up to 4 builders per team, others may advise

4.4 Round 4: Blind Taste Test

This sensory challenge puts taste buds to the test. Blindfolded team members must identify various foods, condiments, and beverages by taste alone. Items range from the obvious (chocolate, orange juice) to the tricky (soy sauce vs. Worcestershire sauce, different types of cheese). Each team selects two representatives for the taste test while the rest of the team can offer encouragement but no hints. The round generates plenty of surprised reactions and laughter, especially when confident contestants confidently misidentify something obvious.

Format: 10 items to identify, 30 seconds per item

Points: 4 points per correct identification, 2 points for partial identification (e.g., correct category)

Participants: 2 blindfolded tasters per team

4.5 Round 5: The Grand Finale Quiz Showdown

The final round is a high-stakes quiz showdown that can dramatically shift the leaderboard. Teams face rapid-fire questions worth double points, with categories drawn from all previous rounds plus wildcard topics. The twist is that each team may challenge another team to a head-to-head duel on a single question, with the winner taking the full points and the loser receiving zero. This mechanic introduces strategic decision-making and creates climactic moments as teams gamble their positions on their strongest subject areas. The Grand Finale is designed to keep the outcome unpredictable until the very last question, ensuring maximum excitement for participants and spectators alike.

Format: 15 rapid-fire questions, double points, duel mechanic

Points: 10 points per correct answer, 0 for incorrect; duels are winner-takes-all

Participants: Entire team may confer

5. Scoring System

Points are accumulated across all five rounds. The team with the highest total at the end of the Grand Finale is declared the overall winner. In the event of a tie, a sudden-death tiebreaker question is asked, and the first team to answer correctly wins. The scoring structure is designed to ensure that no single round can determine the outcome, rewarding consistent performance while keeping every round meaningful.

Round	Activity	Max Points	Scoring Method
1	Table Trivia	100	5 pts correct / 3 pts steal

2	Food Relay Race	25	Placement-based
3	Table Building	30	Height + creativity bonus
4	Blind Taste Test	40	Per correct identification
5	Grand Finale Quiz	150	Double points + duel wins

Table 2: Scoring Breakdown by Round

Bonus Points: Teams can earn up to 5 bonus points in Round 3 for creative design, as judged by the event panel. Additionally, the team that demonstrates the best sportsmanship throughout the competition, as voted by the other teams at the end of the event, receives a 10-point Sportsmanship Bonus. This encourages positive behaviour and ensures that the competitive spirit remains friendly and respectful from start to finish.

6. Rules and Regulations

All participants must adhere to the following rules to ensure a fair, safe, and enjoyable competition for everyone involved. These rules are non-negotiable and will be enforced by the event organisers and supervising staff throughout the entire programme.

- â■ Fair Play: All teams must compete honestly. Cheating, whether by sharing answers between teams, using unauthorized materials, or interfering with another team's performance, will result in immediate disqualification from the current round and a 15-point deduction from the team's cumulative score.
- â■ Respect for Opponents: Trash talk should remain lighthearted and good-natured. Personal insults, intimidation, or aggressive behaviour will not be tolerated and may result in individual or team penalties at the discretion of the organisers.
- â■ Safety First: During physical challenges (especially the Food Relay Race), participants must follow all safety instructions from the event staff. Running in designated areas only, no pushing or tripping, and proper footwear must be worn at all times. Any participant who feels unwell should inform their captain immediately.
- â■ Substitutions: If a team member is unable to participate in a specific round due to health or personal reasons, the vice captain or another designated substitute may take their place. No team may use a non-table-member as a substitute. Substitutions must be communicated to the organisers before the round begins.
- â■ Scoring Disputes: Any dispute regarding scoring must be raised by the team captain to the head judge within two minutes of the round ending. The head judge's decision is final. Video replays will not be used.
- â■ Equipment Care: All materials and equipment provided for the competition must be used responsibly. Intentional damage or waste of materials will result in a 5-point penalty per

incident. At the end of the Table Building Challenge, teams are responsible for cleaning up their station.

7. Event Schedule

The Table Wars Competition is designed to fit within a single evening programme, allowing residents to enjoy the full event without disrupting their academic schedules. The timeline below provides a structured flow for the event, with buffer time built in for transitions between rounds. The event coordinator should monitor the schedule closely and make adjustments as needed to ensure a smooth experience for all participants.

Time	Activity	Duration	Details
6:00 PM	Setup and Arrival	30 min	Teams gather, receive materials, final captain briefing
6:30 PM	Opening Ceremony	15 min	Welcome, rules overview, team introductions and chants
6:45 PM	Round 1: Table Trivia	25 min	20 trivia questions with steal rules
7:10 PM	Round 2: Food Relay	25 min	Timed relay races with food-themed obstacles
7:35 PM	Refreshment Break	10 min	Drinks and snacks provided for all participants
7:45 PM	Round 3: Table Building	20 min	15 min build + 5 min judging
8:05 PM	Round 4: Blind Taste Test	20 min	10 items, 2 tasters per team
8:25 PM	Round 5: Grand Finale	25 min	Double-point quiz with duel mechanic
8:50 PM	Score Tallying	10 min	Final scores calculated, sportsmanship vote
9:00 PM	Awards Ceremony	15 min	Winner announcement, prizes, group photo

Table 3: Event Schedule Timeline

8. Prizes and Awards

The prize structure is designed to celebrate achievement while maintaining the fun, community-focused spirit of the event. The grand prize carries real practical value in the boarding house context, while the additional awards recognise different forms of excellence and contribution

throughout the competition.

Award	Recipient	Prize
Champion Table	1st place overall	First position at mealtimes for one full week
Runner-Up Table	2nd place overall	Second position at mealtimes for one full week
Most Creative Team	Best team identity and chant	Trophy and dessert privilege for one night
Sportsmanship Award	Voted by other teams	Certificate and 10 bonus points towards next event
MVP of the Night	Outstanding individual performer	Certificate and special meal upgrade

Table 4: Prizes and Awards

The meal position privilege is the centrepiece of the prize system and serves as the primary motivator for competitive effort. The winning table will be announced at dinner the evening after the competition, and the privilege takes effect immediately from the following breakfast and lasts for seven consecutive days. This practical reward ensures that the competition has a tangible, daily-impact outcome that keeps the excitement alive well beyond the event night itself.

9. Equipment and Materials

Proper preparation of equipment and materials is essential for a smooth-running event. The following inventory should be assembled and verified at least one day before the competition. The event coordinator is responsible for ensuring all items are available and in good condition, with backups on hand for critical supplies.

Round	Required Items	Quantity
General	Scoreboard (whiteboard or flip chart)	1
General	Markers, pens, and notepads for judges	5 sets
General	Team identifier items (coloured bands or sashes)	Per team
General	Whistle and stopwatch	2 each
Round 1	Printed trivia questions and answer sheets	Per team + host

Round 2	Plates, trays, cups, bowls, and obstacle course items	Per team
Round 3	Cardboard, newspaper, tape, string, plastic cups, scissors	Per team kit
Round 4	10 food/drink samples, blindfolds, tasting spoons, napkins	Per team
Round 5	Printed quiz cards, duel tokens, buzzer system	Per team + host

Table 5: Equipment and Materials Checklist

10. Staff and Supervision

A well-staffed event ensures safety, fairness, and smooth operations. The following roles should be filled by boarding house staff, senior students, or designated volunteers. Each role is critical to the success of the event, and all staff members should be briefed on their responsibilities at least one hour before the event begins.

Role	Responsibility	Recommended Count
Event Coordinator	Oversees entire event, manages schedule, handles disputes	1
Host / MC	Presents questions, announces rounds, keeps energy high	1
Head Judge	Makes final scoring decisions, resolves disputes	1
Round Judges	Score individual rounds, verify answers, monitor compliance	2-3
Scorekeeper	Maintains official scoreboard, tallies running totals	1
Safety Monitors	Supervise physical challenges, enforce safety rules, first aid	2
Setup / Cleanup Crew	Arrange equipment, reset stations between rounds, tidy up	3-4

Table 6: Staff Roles and Recommended Count

The Event Coordinator has ultimate authority over the running of the competition. In the event of any unforeseen circumstances, such as equipment failure, safety concerns, or weather-related issues (if any portion of the event is held outdoors), the Coordinator may pause, modify, or reschedule rounds at their discretion. All staff should have the Coordinator's mobile number for immediate

communication during the event.

11. Contingency Plan

While the Table Wars Competition is designed to run smoothly, it is important to have contingency measures in place for common disruptions. The following scenarios and responses ensure that the event can adapt to unexpected situations without losing momentum or compromising the experience for participants.

â **Time Overrun:** If any round exceeds its allotted time, the Event Coordinator may reduce the number of questions or items in subsequent rounds. The Grand Finale round can be shortened from 15 to 10 questions if needed. The Awards Ceremony time is protected and should not be cut short.

â **Equipment Shortage:** Backup supplies for critical items (plates, cups, tape, blindfolds) should be kept in a designated reserve box. If materials run short, the Table Building Challenge can be simplified by reducing the available materials per team while maintaining the same judging criteria.

â **Medical Incident:** Safety Monitors are equipped with a basic first aid kit. In the event of a minor injury, the affected participant is attended to immediately and the round continues with their substitute. For more serious incidents, the round is paused and emergency protocols are activated. The nearest hospital or clinic contact details should be posted at the registration desk.

â **Low Participation:** If attendance is lower than expected, teams may be merged to ensure a minimum of three competing groups. The scoring system remains the same regardless of the number of teams, ensuring fairness.